

028. Chapter 3 Verses 4-6

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.4

न कर्मणामनारम्भात्तैश्कर्म्यं पुरुषोऽश्नुते ।
न च संन्यसनादेव सिद्धिं समधिगच्छति ॥ ४ ॥

na karmaṇām anārambhāt taiśkarmyam puruṣho 'śhnute
na cha sannyasanād eva siddhiṁ samadhigachchhati

na—not; karmaṇām—of actions; anārambhāt—by abstaining from; naiśhkarmyam—freedom from karmic reactions; puruṣhaḥ—a person; aśhnute—attains; na—not; cha—and; sannyasanāt—by renunciation; eva—only; siddhim—perfection; samadhigachchhati—attains

Man does not match the actionless state of Brahman by mere non-performance of work, nor does he attain perfection by renunciation only.

VERSE 3.5

न हि कश्चित्क्षणमपि जातु तिष्ठत्यकर्मकृत् ।
कार्यते ह्यवशः कर्म सर्वः प्रकृतिजैर्गुणैः ॥ ५ ॥

na hi kaśhchit kṣhaṇam api jātu tiṣṭhatyakarma-kṛit
kāryate hyavaśhaḥ karma sarvaḥ prakṛiti-jair guṇaiḥ

na—not; hi—certainly; kaśhchit—anyone; kṣhaṇam—a moment; api—even; jātu—ever; tiṣṭhathi—can remain; akarma-kṛit—without action; kāryate—are performed; hi—certainly; avaśhaḥ—helpless; karma—work; sarvaḥ—all; prakṛiti-jaiḥ—born of material nature; guṇaiḥ—by the qualities

No one can live even for a moment without doing work. Everyone without his will is made to do work by the qualities born of Prakriti.

कर्मेन्द्रियाणि संयम्य य आस्ते मनसा स्मरन् ।
इन्द्रियार्थान्विमूढात्मा मिथ्याचारः स उच्यते ॥६॥

karmendriyāṇi sanyamya ya āste manasā smaran
indriyārthān vimūḍhātmā mithyāchāraḥ sa uchyate

karma-indriyāṇi—the organs of action; **sanyamya**—restrain; **yaḥ**—who; **āste**—remain; **manasā**—in the mind; **smaran**—to remember; **indriya-arthān**—sense objects; **vimūḍha-ātmā**—the deluded; **mithyā-āchāraḥ**—hypocrite; **saḥ**—they; **uchyate**—are called

The man of deluded understanding who restraining the organs of the action sits contemplating the sense objects with the mind is called a hypocrite.